

# Marcus Chen

Site Reliability Engineer

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GitHub Bluesky

SRE with a passion for observability, incident response, and building platforms that stay up when everything else is on fire. Former backend engineer turned reliability advocate.

## EXPERIENCE

### Staff Site Reliability Engineer

Jan 2022 – Present

StreamVault · Remote (US)

*Own reliability for core ingestion pipeline and global CDN edge configuration.*

- Cut P99 latency 38% by redesigning autoscaling policies on Kubernetes.
- Introduced SLO/error-budget culture; reduced customer-facing incidents by 52% YoY.
- Led postmortem program adopted company-wide with blameless review templates.

### Platform Engineer

Jun 2018 – Dec 2021

DataPipe Inc. · Austin, TX

*Built internal developer platform on AWS EKS with Terraform and Helm.*

- Migrated 40+ microservices from EC2 to EKS with zero planned downtime windows.
- Implemented OpenTelemetry tracing across 100% of production services.

## VOLUNTEER

### Program Committee Volunteer

Sep 2024 – Mar 2025

DevOpsDays SF

*Reviewed talk proposals and curated reliability track sessions.*

- Selected 18 talks from 200+ submissions.
- Moderated opening keynote panel on AI-assisted incident response.

## EDUCATION

### Georgia Institute of Technology

2016 – 2018

Master of Science, Computer Science · 3.9/4.0

- CS 6210: Advanced Operating Systems
- CS 6476: Computer Vision
- CS 8803: Cloud Computing

## PROJECTS

### OnCall Roulette

Jan 2023 – Jun 2023

StreamVault (internal open source) · application · Author, Maintainer

*Fair rotation scheduler with timezone-aware handoffs and PTO blackout support.*

Go, Slack API, Scheduling, SRE tooling

- Used by 30+ teams at StreamVault.
- Exports iCal feeds and Slack reminders.

## SLO Burn Talk

Mar 2025 – Mar 2025

USENIX · conference · Speaker, Writer

*Conference talk on multi-window burn-rate alerting for tier-1 services.*

SLO, Alerting, Reliability

- Presented at SREcon Americas 2025.
- Slides downloaded 8,000+ times.

## SKILLS

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### Observability

Master — Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, OpenTelemetry, Loki

### Infrastructure as Code

Master — Terraform, Pulumi, Helm, Crossplane

### Incident Management

Senior — PagerDuty, Statuspage, Blameless postmortems, Chaos engineering

## AWARDS

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### Golden SLO Award

2025

StreamVault Engineering

Awarded for achieving 99.99% availability across ingestion tier for four consecutive quarters.

## CERTIFICATES

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### Certified Kubernetes Administrator

Aug 2023

Cloud Native Computing Foundation

### AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional

Apr 2022

Amazon Web Services

### HashiCorp Terraform Associate

2021

HashiCorp

## PUBLICATIONS

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### Error Budgets That Engineers Actually Use

Nov 2024

SRE Weekly

Practical patterns for tying product priorities to reliability investment without dashboard fatigue.

## LANGUAGES

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**English** — Native

**Mandarin** — Conversational

## INTERESTS

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## **Mechanical Keyboards**

Custom builds, Ergo layouts, Soldering

## **Trail Running**

Ultra distances, Marin Headlands, Elevation training

## **REFERENCES**

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### **Lisa Park**

Marcus turned our reliability culture from reactive firefighting into measurable engineering discipline. He is exceptional at teaching SLO thinking to product teams.